

» AFTER

The strategic initiative in the East passed to the Confederates. As the Union army reorganized, Lee's next major move would be the advance to Gettysburg.

SALEM CHURCH



CASUALTIES AT MARYE'S HEIGHTS

Union Major General Sedgwick and his Sixth Corps attacked Jubal Early at Fredericksburg on the morning of May 3. They pushed him off Marye's Heights, and proceeded west down the Orange Turnpike toward Lee's rear. **A desperate stand by Brigadier General Cadmus Wilcox's Rebel brigade** at Salem Church stopped Sedgwick cold. The next day, the **Confederates launched a series of uncoordinated assaults** on Sedgwick, who beat each of them off in turn and escaped relatively unscathed back across the river. Confronting his tired and unsuccessful division commanders, Robert E. Lee reportedly lost his temper over this lost opportunity.

"WHAT WILL THE PEOPLE SAY?"

Upon hearing **news of Hooker's withdrawal** across the Rappahannock River, a horrified **President Lincoln** turned to a colleague and said, "My God, my God, what will the people say?" Yet another campaign in the East had come to nothing. **Northern morale plummeted.**